



ABWCI ROUNDUP

2024 | NOVEMBER | DECEMBER
2025 | JANUARY | FEBRUARY | MARCH



Empowering women in business through a supportive ecosystem, fostering equity, and inclusive prosperity, for a thriving society.



www.abwci.org

Fostering Businesses, Impacting Economies

In this edition, you'll explore the incredible efforts, accomplishments, and inspiring journeys of our global leaders and community members who are transforming the entrepreneurial landscape.

Their stories, insights, and achievements serve as a source of inspiration and motivation. Through our supportive network, we are empowering women to drive the future of global economies.

At ABWCI, we remain committed to building a dynamic business environment where women can thrive. Together, we are shaping a world where every woman's entrepreneurial vision leaves a lasting mark.

Happy Reading!

IN THIS EDITION



01. Welcoming our Country Presidents
02. Journey Highlights
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Connecting #WomenInBusiness to the world of possibilities! Join our digital journey!



OUR IMPACT

OVER THE YEARS

1,30,000+

Direct and Indirect Members

40+

Country based leaders
expanding our Global Footprint

50+

Business Associations &
Women Networks

30+

MoUs with Business
Associations, Educational
Institutions, Incubation Centers
and Networking Forums

50+

Outreach events organised globally

130+

Languages supported

\$15M

Funds mobilized for women
in business

WELCOMING OUR COUNTRY PRESIDENTS

"Your leadership and vision continue to shape a thriving entrepreneurial ecosystem, empowering women to break barriers and drive meaningful change."

ASHKHEN KHACHATRYAN

ARMENIA



A personal branding coach and advocate for India-Armenia ties, with a Master's in Economics and diverse sector experience. She specializes in helping professionals craft and communicate their unique identities. Passionate about promoting Armenian heritage, she fosters cultural exchange and drives impact through coaching, public engagement, and strategic personal development.

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DIANA RODRÍGUEZ RODAS

PERU



A Businesswoman and lawyer specializing in Corporate Social Responsibility, with a Master's in Administration and Public Management. She leads the Peruvian Women's Chamber of Commerce and Mujer Emprende Peru, driving innovation, inclusion, and women's economic empowerment in business and law.

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MÓNICA MARTÍNEZ VARGAS

CHILE

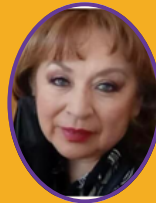


A transformation strategist and women's empowerment advocate, serving as Executive Director of Strategy 2 Succeed and Partner at SOUL.com where she drives human-centered change. With an engineering degree, MBA, and project management expertise, she promotes ethical leadership and global collaboration through ebbf Latam and GCBL.

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NANCY SOLEDAD VINELLI AGUIRRE

ECUADOR



A distinguished lawyer and mediator with a Doctorate in Law, specializing in gender equality, social justice, and legal accessibility. As Founder of Vinelli & Asociados and a Business and Professional Women (BPW) leader, she champions women's rights and economic empowerment through legal reforms. At CENSOL Quito, she heads mediation efforts, with notable achievements like legalizing 500 property deeds for vulnerable families.

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ROCÍO MILAGROS COLLANTES GONZÁLEZ

PANAMA



An international relations expert and legal consultant advancing women's empowerment, sustainability, and global policy. She has shaped gender initiatives at CEPAL and UNICEF Panama, and empowers women through education and entrepreneurship. Her work earned her the Octavio Méndez Pereira Medal.

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DEVORA MEZA

GUATEMALA



A digital transformation, AI and cybersecurity leader with a PhD in Security and a background in Systems Engineering. Former Vice Minister of ICT, she champions innovation and gender equity in tech. Named a Science Heroine by SENACYT and one of Forbes' 100 Most Powerful Women, she shapes Guatemala's tech future and empowers women in STEM.

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PRESIDENT FOR NORTHEAST INDIA



Dr. Alakananda Das

A social entrepreneur driving rural empowerment and sustainability through innovative design and cultural heritage. As Founder & CEO of Looms Ecopreneur Federation, she supports rural weavers and leads the Looms Conclave to build impactful partnerships. Active in the India ASEAN Business Council and G100, she advocates for sustainable practices and global collaboration.

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JOURNEY HIGHLIGHTS

PARTNERSHIPS

Throughout the period, we forged meaningful partnerships with organizations aligned with our mission, amplifying collective impact and driving global collaboration for women's empowerment.

NOVEMBER

EKHOS

EKHOS



EKHOS, a Latin America-based organization, fosters impactful collaboration between women entrepreneurs across India and Latin America. The partnership aimed to build a strong bridge of opportunity, innovation, and shared purpose between the two regions. The collaboration also supported the development of GIBEF 2025, a global initiative focused on expanding inclusive, women-led enterprises.

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NOVEMBER

JUBILANT BHARTI FOUNDATION



BHARAT IMPACT

JBF is a not for profit Organisation established in 2007 by Jubilant Bhartia Group. They are on a mission to develop multi-stakeholder sustainable models to bring about 'social change' involving knowledge generation & sharing, experiential learning and entrepreneurial ecosystem.

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DECEMBER

WOMENLINES

WOMENLINES
Promoting Excellence In Women
Enlightening. Empowering. Enabling Women

It is a leading online platform that offers a suite of content marketing services to help brands amplify their voices and make a meaningful impact on women's lives worldwide through inspiring stories, expert insights, and valuable resources. The company was ranked 3rd in FeedSpot's top 20 online women's empowerment magazines.

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NOVEMBER

ASIAN SCHOOL OF BUSINESS



A premier institution on a mission to nurture agile leaders of high integrity, grounded in strong values, and equipped with the critical thinking and decision-making abilities for leading organizational transformations in today's disruptive technological environment. The partnership will help to create an enabling ecosystem and countless opportunities for women in business and aspiring entrepreneurs!

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EVENTS, CONFERENCES & SUMMITS...

HER Courage Leaders Summit 2025

Parul Soni, as a Mentor and Co- Partner, actively contributed to the HER Courage Leaders Summit 2025, fostering dialogue on women's leadership and empowerment. The event highlighted inspiring stories, meaningful collaborations, and the celebration of fearless women leaders.

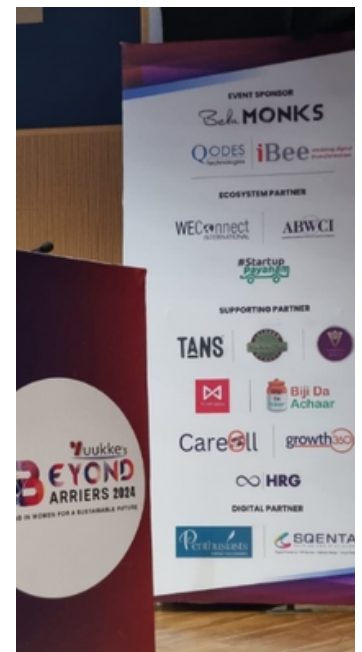
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#TogetherWeCanMakeADifference



Beyond Barriers 2024

ABCWI Partnered for Yukkee's Beyond Barriers 2024, ABCWI proudly supported this powerful platform focused on investing in women for a sustainable future. The event showcased innovation, impact, and collaboration — inspiring steps toward breaking barriers and building inclusive ecosystems for women in business.

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ABWCI at ALEAP's INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCE

ABWCI participated in ALEAP's International Conference (March 7-9, 2025, Vijayawada), where Vidya Manmohan, ABWCI's UAE President and Savita Sethi, Director of Programmes of ABWCI shared insights on fostering sustainable, women-led enterprises. The event focused on innovation, inclusion, and global collaboration for empowering entrepreneurs.

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GIBEF 2025

18-21 Feb

ABWCI and Ekhos co-hosted the **Global Impact Businesses and Ecosystem Forum (GIBEF) 2025**, bringing together global leaders, policymakers, and entrepreneurs to discuss sustainable growth, circular economy solutions, and international business collaboration.



The event was graced by **Ms. Smriti Irani**, Former Cabinet Minister and Young Global Leader of the World Economic Forum, who shared inspiring insights on gender equality, innovation, and economic development.



COLLABORATION IN ACTION: NETWORKS DRIVING IMPACT BUSINESS SUCCESS

The panel highlighted how global networks drive social and impact enterprise growth. **Moderated by Graciela De Oto, and Savita Sethi**, as panelist, the session emphasized the role of strategic partnerships and collaboration in scaling impact, expanding reach, and fostering business success across diverse regions.

BRIDGING THREE CONTINENTS: OPPORTUNITIES ACROSS INDIA, LATAM, AND THE UK

This global panel talked about strengthening economic partnerships and innovation across India, Latin America, and the UK. **Moderated by Parul Soni (ABWCI)**, the discussion fosters cross-border collaboration and sustainable growth.



[READ MORE ABOUT GIBEF HERE](#)

DISCUSSIONS, VISITS & AWARDS...

PANEL DISCUSSION: Borderless Business Opportunities

As part of the Together We Grow initiative, ABWCI partnered as the Ecosystem Collaborator for a high-impact panel discussion on 'Borderless Business Opportunities' in Bangalore. The session brought together global women leaders including representatives from Nepal, Sri Lanka, the Philippines, Kyrgyz Republic, and Canada, alongside Indian trade experts. Moderated by ABWCI's Founder & Secretary General Mr. Parul Soni, the panel explored strategies to boost cross-border trade for women-led businesses. An inspiring exchange of ideas, the session reinforced the importance of global collaboration in empowering women entrepreneurs.

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Regional President of South America visits ABWCI Headquarters

ABWCI was honored to host Graciela De Oto, Regional President – South America & Country President – Argentina, at its Global Secretariat. The strategic meeting brought together key leaders to strengthen the shared mission of empowering women entrepreneurs worldwide. The visit was a testament of ABWCI's collaboration, innovation, and visionary leadership, reaffirming its commitment to meaningful global impact.

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ADVAITA WOMEN AWARDS

At the Advaita Women Entrepreneur Awards 2024 in New Delhi, ABWCI CEO joined a dynamic panel alongside the Founders of Women Inspiring Network, New Age Mompreneurs, and the Chief Guest, Founder of Momwearsprada, for an engaging conversation on "Viksit Bharat:

The Role of Women Entrepreneurs." The session spotlighted the transformative impact of women entrepreneurs in shaping India's growth through innovation, leadership, and enterprise.

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ABWCI
COLLABORATED WITH
SMBCONNECT
TO RECOGNISE SOME
INCREDIBLE WOMEN
ENTREPRENEURS AND
THEIR BUSINESSES!

PROJECTS, INITIATIVES AND MUCH MORE

PROJECT GRAMEEN HEROES

ABWCI, with support from Hero MotoCorp, is implementing this initiative as a rural adaptation of the Shark Tank model. The program aims to empower rural women entrepreneurs with scalable business ideas by providing funding, mentorship, and capacity-building support. Currently active in 5 states, the initiative has reached over 1,500 women and shortlisted more than 350 high-potential entrepreneurs for state- and national-level pitch rounds. Of these, 35 women have been selected to receive seed grants to scale up their businesses.

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WE4WE INITIATIVE

Women Entrepreneurs for Women Enterprises (WE4WE) is an ongoing joint initiative by ABWCI and Passing Gifts Pvt. Ltd. (PGPL) that supports women-led FPOs in Odisha through **mentorship, capacity-building, and market linkages** to create sustainable rural enterprises.

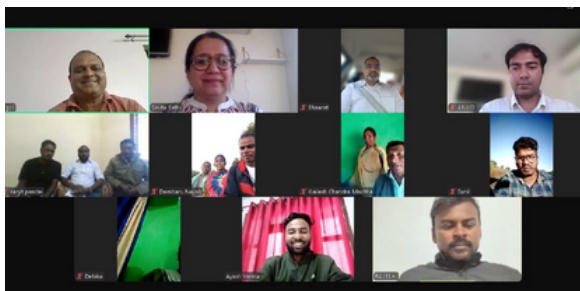
ABWCI hosted a virtual mentoring session for women-led FPOs. **Bindu Mehrotra, founder of Bindu's Herbal Products**, shared her entrepreneurial journey and practical insights. The session focused on navigating business challenges and strengthening rural women's confidence and capabilities.

NOVEMBER

As part of Global Entrepreneurship Week, ABWCI hosted another mentoring session under WE4WE. **Madhushree N. Deshpande, founder of Silver Spoon Enterprises**, engaged with women entrepreneurs, offering guidance and support to overcome business hurdles and build confidence.

WE4WE

Women Entrepreneurs for Women Entrepreneurs



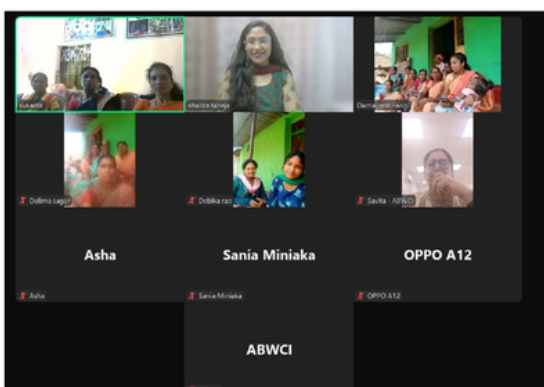
Mentoring Session by Ayush Verma

Focused on strengthening market linkages, the month saw strategic meetings with **Kissansay.com** to improve governance, optimize business operations, and drive long-term success. The mentoring sessions were kept generic to build rapport and introduce entrepreneurial concepts to the entrepreneurs.

JANUARY

This month saw a leap toward export preparedness for FPOs. A detailed session by **Ayush Verma, CTO of Green Supply** covered packaging, documentation, and compliance for international trade. FPOs began prepping digital content for e-commerce listings. Green Supply also showed interest in procurement.

FEBRUARY



Focus this month was on digital branding and certification. **Dr. Shailza Taneja** conducted a session on setting up social media pages for FPOs.

MARCH

[READ MORE ABOUT PGPL HERE](#)

COUNTRY CHAPTERS



SWITZERLAND

◆ Dejan Štancer, Global Ambassador was invited to speak at the Woman Business Circle UAE National Day Celebration on December 1, 2024, honoring his commitment to women's empowerment and global business leadership.

USA

◆ Larisa B. Miller, Global Ambassador at ABWCI and CEO of Phoenix Global, launched www.LarisaMiller.com to share her journey, insights, and books aimed at empowering leaders to navigate disruption with innovation and purpose.

◆ She contributed to the book *The Rising Role of Women in Family Offices and Family Businesses*, where she authored a chapter on balancing tradition with innovation—highlighting how emerging technologies like AI and blockchain can enhance legacy structures. [Get your copy here](#)

◆ She also got featured on the cover of BOSS Magazine, where she was recognized for her leadership and collaboration with Mohammed Al Muhairi in transforming global business through Phoenix Global's future-focused strategies.

◆ She delivered a keynote at the League of Leading Ladies Conference 2025 in Switzerland, emphasizing women's role in tech-driven leadership and the integration of AI for inclusive, sustainable business innovation.



THE BOARDROOM AFRICA Congratulations ESG Certificate Graduates



SINGAPORE

◆ Lilian Ong, Country President of Singapore, hosted the first monthly Women of Courage Asia (WOCA) Empowerment Meeting, featuring a masterclass on self-leadership and authenticity to inspire women to embrace their true selves.

◆ She also co-led a collaborative International Women's Day 2025 event with [NTUC U Women & Family](#), celebrating women's resilience, connection, and leadership.

AFRICA

◆ Ngozi Oyewole, Regional President of Africa, graduated from [TheBoardroom Africa's ESG Certificate Programme](#), joining a cohort of 37 leaders committed to advancing sustainable leadership through Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) principles.

NETHERLANDS

- ◆ Frits Bussemaker, Global Ambassador, spoke at CES 2025 on the Startup Stage, sharing insights on how startups can build vibrant communities.
- ◆ At THIMUN 2025, he joined a panel on AI and society, encouraging students to consider ethical, inclusive, and accountable tech futures.
- ◆ Karen van der Zanden, Country President of Netherlands, hosted the SNIC event in Bussum, engaging 1,000 Dutch ICT students on Sustainable IT and encouraging action through the “Circle of Influence” mindset.
- ◆ She concluded her term as Chair of the Nationale Coalitie Duurzame Digitalisering, after nearly two years of advancing sustainable digital practices across the Netherlands.
- ◆ She was featured in LinkedIn’s “Best of Sustainability & Green ICT” for her podcast episode on sustainable software, highlighting the LETSGO project and its impact on energy-efficient digital solutions.



NORWAY

- ◆ Rina Sunder, Country President, Norway, participated as a delegate at the World Woman Davos Agenda held in January 2025, where she joined global changemakers and thought leaders to explore bold ideas and promote transformative impact under the banner of the #EqualityMoonshot.
- ◆ She was invited to the NASSCOM Women in Tech Awards 2024, celebrating women’s inclusion in Indian tech, where she applauded India’s progress in achieving nearly 40% female representation in the IT workforce.
- ◆ She announced the release of the book *The First and Only: India & The Nordics – Breaking Barriers, Building Futures*, which she co-authored to spotlight stories of trailblazing women and cross-cultural leadership between the two regions.



ARGENTINA

- ◆ Graciela De Oto, Regional President of South America and Country President of Argentina, was honored by Acción de Paz on International Women’s Day 2025 with the Diploma de Agradecimiento y Valoración for her leadership in promoting peace and gender equality.
- ◆ She was featured in Global Trends Magazine, where she authored the article “Legacy of Tenacity, Future of Equality.”
- ◆ She also spoke at the First National Meeting of Interreligious Women, advocating for gender equity through interfaith collaboration.



INDIA

- ◆ K. Ratna Prabha IAS (Retd), Global Ambassador delivered an inspiring talk at Christ University, Bangalore in March 2025, sharing strategic insights on civil service careers and advocating for stronger gender equity in administration.
- ◆ Valerie Pinto, Global Ambassador was featured in the Top 100 Influential Game Changers 2024 by e4m PR and Corp Comm for her remarkable contributions to the communications industry.
- ◆ Shveta Raina, State President of Maharashtra celebrated a major youth employability program with the Govt. of Maharashtra and EY, impacting over 3,600 participants with a 94% satisfaction rate and notable gains in self-belief and awareness.
- ◆ She was invited as a Women's Day speaker by BetterPlace, Asia's largest workforce SaaS platform, where she led conversations on inclusive leadership and career transitions.
- ◆ Kumud Sharma, State President of Bihar & Jharkhand and her team at SuperSeva Global Services received the Best Women's Entrepreneurship Award from JLL for their commitment to innovation and leadership in the enterprise support sector.
- ◆ Aparna Mishra, State president of Uttar Pradesh led the EmpowerHer: Financial Growth with Union Bank event in Lucknow, connecting women entrepreneurs with financial tools, schemes, and a strong peer network.
- ◆ Kavitha Rajesh Battula, State President of Telangana & Andhra Pradesh, participated in the Goldman Sachs 10,000 Women event at IIM Bangalore, advocating mentorship and ecosystem growth.
- ◆ She was also honoured with the ALEAP Recognition Award for her contributions to women's entrepreneurship and appointed Secretary of CED-ALEAP, to lead EDP training programs.
- ◆ Sartaj Lamba, State President of Punjab & Chandigarh, received the Wellness Advocate Award for Health and Wellbeing at the Viksit Bharat Summit & Awards 2024.
- ◆ Asha Arondekar, State President of Goa, was felicitated with the Women Super Achiever Award at the 12th World Women Leadership Congress in Mumbai, sharing the platform with global achievers including Shabana Azmi.
- ◆ She was featured in leading Goan newspapers like Navhind Times and Goan Herald as one of the state's top women trailblazers.
- ◆ She also played a key role in the 12th Orchid Awards for Women Achievers of Goa, celebrating excellence across sectors.



SECRETARIAT IN ACTION

Message from Our Founder Secretary General

“

I'm delighted to share that our global community has now expanded to 42 countries—and continues to grow every day.

Empowered women entrepreneurs are more than business leaders—they are the architects of a brighter, more inclusive future. With every venture they create, they spark waves of opportunity, resilience, and prosperity that uplift entire communities.

At ABWCI, we believe that when a woman builds an enterprise, she unleashes a powerful force for change. Her success becomes a beacon of hope and a guiding light for others to follow. Each bold step she takes breaks barriers, challenges norms, and opens doors for the next generation of women leaders.

To every aspiring woman entrepreneur:

Believe in your vision. Trust your journey. Take that leap.

Within you lies the power to lead, to innovate, and to inspire.

Together, let's create a world where women not only thrive—but lead the way.

”

Parul Soni Receives Honorary Doctorate

Conferred an **Honorary Doctorate in International Relations & Diplomacy** by **Glory International University, USA**, Parul Soni was recognized for his work in global diplomacy and social impact.

The award was presented in India by Graciela De Oto, Regional President – South America & Country President – Argentina. He dedicated the honor to his mentors, team, and family, reinforcing his mission to empower women and drive sustainable development.

This recognition highlights his unwavering dedication to women's economic empowerment, inclusive leadership, and sustainable development through strategic partnerships and impactful initiatives.

As he steps into this new chapter, he reaffirms his commitment to fostering global cooperation, driving systemic change, and creating inclusive opportunities for all.

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SECRETARIAT IN ACTION

PANEL DISCUSSION ON ADVANCING WOMEN IN INVESTMENT INDUSTRY: BARRIERS, OPPORTUNITIES & LEVERS



The UK Government hosted a panel discussion on increasing inclusion in the investment industry, where Parul Soni spoke on ensuring women have equal access to capital, networks, and leadership roles.

In the Frame (L-R) Sally Taylor, Minister Counsellor, British High Commission (Moderator); Panel Members- **Parul Soni**, Founder, ABWCI; **Rajat Arora**, Head of Asia, Women's World Banking Asset Management; **Tanya Singhal**, Founder, SolarArise & Mynzo Carbon; **Rahul Bhasin**, Managing Partner, Baring Private Equity Partners



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Strategic Dialogue on Climate-Resilient Agriculture with Passing Gifts

Parul Soni facilitated a key multi-stakeholder engagement with Passing Gifts (Heifer International), the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmer Welfare, and global partners.

The focus: advancing climate resilience and sustainable agriculture in India.

Highlights included support for the government's Climate Resilient Agriculture (CRA) initiative, collaboration across Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, and Bihar, and strategic synergies with organizations like GAIN, GGGI, and Climate Asia to empower farmers and promote sustainable rural development.

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The Modern India Podcast

The podcast talked about the urgent need for gender equality in business. Parul Soni emphasized ABWCI's efforts to empower women entrepreneurs and shared global strategies to boost female participation in India's workforce.

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STAY TUNED FOR MORE !!!

GET IN TOUCH



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SCAN TO LEARN MORE



*Empowering women today,
reshaping the world tomorrow!*